

comes with two USB Type-A ports, one on either end of the laptop. So it doesn't matter if you hold the mouse using your left or right hand, you'd have a port available. The Envy x360 15 also gets two Thunderbolt 4 ports, an HDMI port, a full-size SD card slot, and a headphone jack. In other words, a pretty impressive I/O port selection for a 15-inch thin and light laptop.

SCREEN AND SPEAKERS

The HP Envy x15 360 variant which I received, the OLED one, has a 15.6-inch FHD IPS display that can support a maximum refresh rate of 60Hz. It is a pretty bright display as HP claims 400nits of peak brightness. However, while testing, I found the display's peak brightness to be around 342nits. I found the luminance to be enough, for both indoor and outdoor conditions. But my issue with the display is its low colour accuracy. Considering the laptop has a touch screen, comes with a touch pen and has a 360-degree hinge, its display not being colour accurate is kind of a disappointment. I tested the OLED panel but the laptop also has an and that is the highest variant available. So if you want a colour accurate viewing experience this display won't suffice. Moving on to the speakers, they are pretty good. HP's focus is more on clarity instead of base but I think the final result pays off.

BELLS AND WHISTLES

The Envy x15 360 comes with an IMAX certification. And it basically means that the laptop's display and screen will come together to enhance your viewing experience for select content. As of right now, some Disney Hotstar content supports this with more to come. HP also has plans to bring the same certification to its other laptop sub-brands including Pavilion and more. The next unique thing about the Envy x360 15 is the 5MP front camera. It offers good image quality and is a boon for video calls.

PERFORMANCE

Performance is another area because

SSD SPEED TEST		
LAPTOP	SSD READ SPEED (MB/S)	SSD WRITE SPEED (MB/S)
HP ENVY X360 15	3031.21	1656.06
HP PAVILION AERO 13	3373.35	2806.52
LENOVO YOGA 9i (1360P)	7097.2	6145.3

of which I'd recommend you to go for the laptop's top-end model instead. The variant I reviewed comes with an Intel Core i5-1335U processor. For the uninitiated, the Intel "U" series processors are suitable for basic multitasking and not for heavy workloads. The top variant also comes with an Intel Core i7 "U" series chip. And while it is definitely a step up from the CPU I tested, I sincerely think that an "H" series processor would be a much better fit for this kind of laptop. And another thing for which I'd be more likely to recommend this laptop's top model is the presence of an Nvidia RTX 3050 dGPU. A thin and light laptop with an OLED display and a dGPU on the side is kind of a killer combination.

Coming back to the variant at hand, it is good enough for normal stuff and is geared more towards efficiency. On average it consumes between 20-25W when performing everyday tasks. When idle, the same usage drops down to as low as 5W. The power draw is consistent although the laptop's performance does throttles quite a bit under stress as indicated by the nearly 2000-point drop in its Cinebench R23 score. For reference, there is a mere 300 point drop (approx.) in the performance of an Intel 1360P's Cinebench R23 score powering the new 14-inch Lenovo Yoga 9i. So this is an area where HP Envy x360 15 needs some improvement. Lastly, the 512GB SSD onboard has a decent read speed of 3031MB/s but a relatively slow write

speed of 1656MB/s. While you won't notice much difference in loading apps if the read speed is over 3000MB/s, you will notice the slowness when copying large files.

VERDICT

The HP Envy x360 15 is a 2-in-1 laptop with a price tag of Rs 99,999 for the OLED Intel Core i5 version. Its design and build quality stand out, featuring recycled aluminium and ocean-bound plastic in its construction, and a 360-degree hinge for versatile use. The laptop's 15.6-inch FHD OLED panel, while bright at 342nits, disappoints in colour accuracy. The keyboard and trackpad offer a comfortable experience, and the device has an impressive I/O port selection. Performance-wise, the Intel Core i5-1335U processor is geared more towards efficiency rather than heavy workloads, consuming 20-25W for everyday tasks. Its SSD has a decent read speed but a slower write speed, noticeable when copying large files. The top model includes an RTX 3050 dGPU, which is more appealing for those in need of better performance.

The laptop also comes with features such as IMAX certification and a high-resolution front camera. Despite good speaker quality, the shortcomings in performance and display might deter some buyers. While the design, build quality, and premium feel are commendable, the less powerful processor, colour-inaccurate display, slow SSD write speed, and lack of a discrete GPU make it a less value-for-money deal. Upgrading to the higher-end variant, priced at Rs 1.35 lakh, for more performance or considering alternatives like the Lenovo Yoga Slim 7i Carbon might be a better option.

—Yetnesh Dubey

SPECIFICATIONS

CPU: Intel Core i5-1335U | GPU: Intel Iris XE integrated graphics | RAM: 16GB LPDDR5 | Display: 15.6-inch FHD IPS LCD panel | Storage: 512GB SSD | Weight: 1.77kg

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